

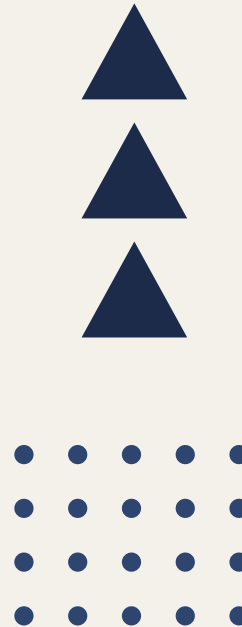
Sales Strategy

Building the Bay Area Market

Interface Education · Sales Manager Take-Home

06.12.2026

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What I'll cover

1

Building the Bay Area market

First 90 days — strategy + execution priorities

2

Following up after a sales event

Two prospects — keep momentum and nurture

3

Discovery conversation

Positioning Interface vs. competitors

4

Closing the deal & handoff

Price hesitancy, sales stages & onboarding

Q1 · My core approach to the Bay Area market

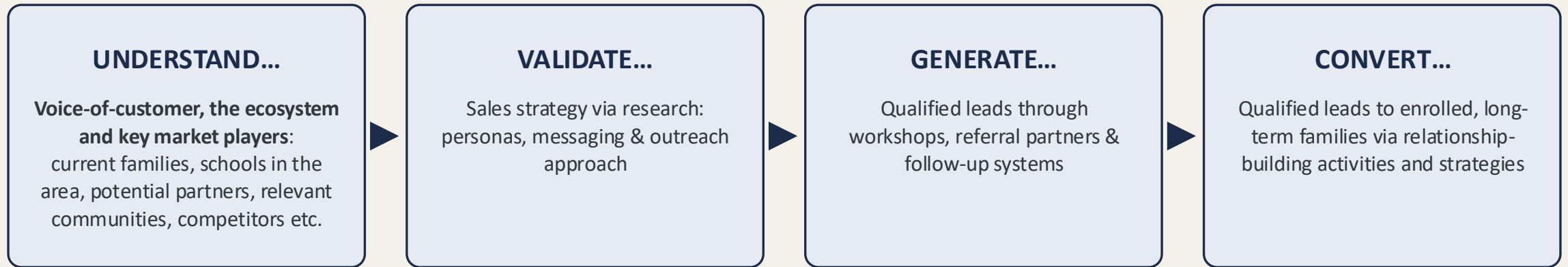
I'd build strategy and pipeline at the same time. I'd make sure to have a clear market map and a strategy that goes with it — I'd build the map, create a strategy that's driven by research, and create a pipeline in parallel.

Starting assumption — to validate

Interface's real value isn't only admissions outcomes — it's **developmental: building a student's genuine readiness and family alignment over time**, with elite admissions as one milestone. Different families weight different parts, so I'd test which message resonates with each.

“Building strategy informed by research” would be one of the first priorities as I step into the role.

Q1 · Strategy: How I'd build before I scale



A continuous loop: I keep selling while I learn — and feed every client interaction and market research back into validating and sharpening the whole strategy (personas, messaging, research & outreach approach) — a work process that serves as a continuous loop, not a one-way flow

Q1 · Strategy: Personas — to identify clients & where each one lives

Why personas: they let me quickly read what a family needs — so I can sharpen my message & outreach, and know which trusted ecosystems to find each one in.

Segment by need

Some sample personas:

Performance-driven

High achievers aiming for elite schools; want positioning and a stronger, more consistent story.

Clarity-seeking

Capable students who lack direction; drawn to purpose, writing, parent alignment & long-term growth.

Where each persona tends to live — trusted ecosystems

- Enrichment programs (research, debate, arts, music)
- Parent & community groups
- Chinese schools / Chinese parent communities
- Private schools, academic tutoring & test-prep networks

These ecosystems then become potential partners and lead generation sources!

Q1 · Channels I'd prioritize — each built to create leads

Channel	Purpose	How it creates qualified leads
Small, high-trust family events	Build trust + direct access to both current and potential families	-Registration + parent questions + post-event follow-up -Invite some current clients to give testimonials (and serve as “star moms”) at the events
Referral partners & collaborations	Build a sustainable channel	Warm introductions from trusted partners, at the moment a family is ready
Voice-of-customer interviews	Validate positioning & strategy	Turn real buying triggers from current & past customers into outreach strategy, event topics & messaging <i>(Where do these families gather? What do they actually need? What makes them decide to enroll?)</i>

Q1 · Differentiation — "Why Interface," not "Why counseling"

In the Bay Area, families may already work with private counselors, coaches, or larger firms. So I'd focus the conversation on **why Interface** — not why counseling.

1

Personalized & developmental

Depth over volume — we build genuine readiness before it's needed, rather than reacting to problems at the last minute.

2

Family alignment

We coach the parents, not just the student, to ensure development and alignment for all parties involved.

3

Longitudinal & integrated

Admissions is one milestone in a longer arc of development — the student gets in and knows why they're there.

Q1 · Execution — first 6 months

Timeline	Priority	Key actions
Month 1	Market mapping + voice of customer	Talk to current families, counselors & the sales team; map the market by researching schools, communities & potential partners
Months 1–3	Partner outreach + message validation	Start partner conversations; test which value proposition resonates
Months 2–6	Pipeline generation	Run a pilot workshop / test event to gauge results; follow up & move qualified leads into consultations

Tradeoff

I'd prioritize a **sustainable, trust-based pipeline** over quick transactional wins. For a high-consideration service, credibility & repeated touchpoints drive durable conversion.

By 6 months I'd have:

- a complete ecosystem map
- a few partner contacts + mapped community touchpoints
- a pilot event run in the area — to evaluate what works & feed back into strategy

Q2 · Following up after the event

In every follow-up I'm a resource person first, not a salesperson — I stay genuinely useful whether or not they buy. That's also how I build & qualify pipeline: trust first, conversion later.

Assumptions: *I had short chats at the event and know a little about each student (e.g., their interests — one in math, one in music). Both families are comfortable in English & Chinese, so I'd open with an English email (more formal) and follow up in Chinese on WeChat — warmer, more personal, and the channel these families use daily.*

PROSPECT 1

Mom + Grade 9 son — attended, skipped the consult

My read: interested, not ready to commit

He showed real interest at the event but skipped the consult — my read is he's curious, just not ready to buy yet. I'd keep the momentum with warm, high-touch (not pushy) follow-up: lead on WeChat, send the email as a professional touch, and keep being a useful resource so his interest builds. Log in CRM and schedule a reminder to follow up periodically.

PROSPECT 2

Mom + Grade 7 daughter

My read: lead with development, not admissions

Interface works with students as young as 3, so Grade 7 is a great time to start — just not with admissions talk. I'd open around other aspects of human development (emotional growth, interest exploration) rather than pure academics, and nurture with value-first resources so the relationship builds naturally.

Q2 · Prospect 1 — keeping momentum (email + WeChat)

Initial email — English

Subject: Great meeting you and your son at the event!

Hi [name],

It was so great meeting you and your son at the event! I just sent you a quick note on WeChat too. 😊

I mostly wanted to reach out to say I'd love to be a resource for your family going forward — whether or not that ever involves working with Interface. If any questions come up about high school planning, summer programs, or just thinking ahead, please feel free to reach out anytime!

I'll also keep you posted on future events I think you might find helpful!

Warmly,
Jamie

Warmer WeChat reply — Chinese (after she replies)

妈妈您好呀～很高兴收到您的回复！您儿子最近怎么样呀？我记得在活动上聊到他对数学挺感兴趣的 😊 今年暑假有没有在考虑相关的项目呢？我这边知道几个挺不错的，很乐意分享给您参考～

我们也想了解您当初是怎么知道我们的，也想听听您这次对活动真实的反馈～如果您孩子对这个暑假计划、或之后升学相关的问题还想多了解，我也可以给您一些初步的建议，很乐意在电话上进一步分享交流哦～

Why Chinese on WeChat: warmer and more personal than email.

CRM logging: I always make sure to log all relevant info in the CRM system, such as “Gr.9 son · email / phone / WeChat · “attended, skipped consult” · schedule a reminder for the next follow-up.”

Q2 · Prospect 2 — nurture (and my real WeChat style)

Nurture message — English

Hi [name],

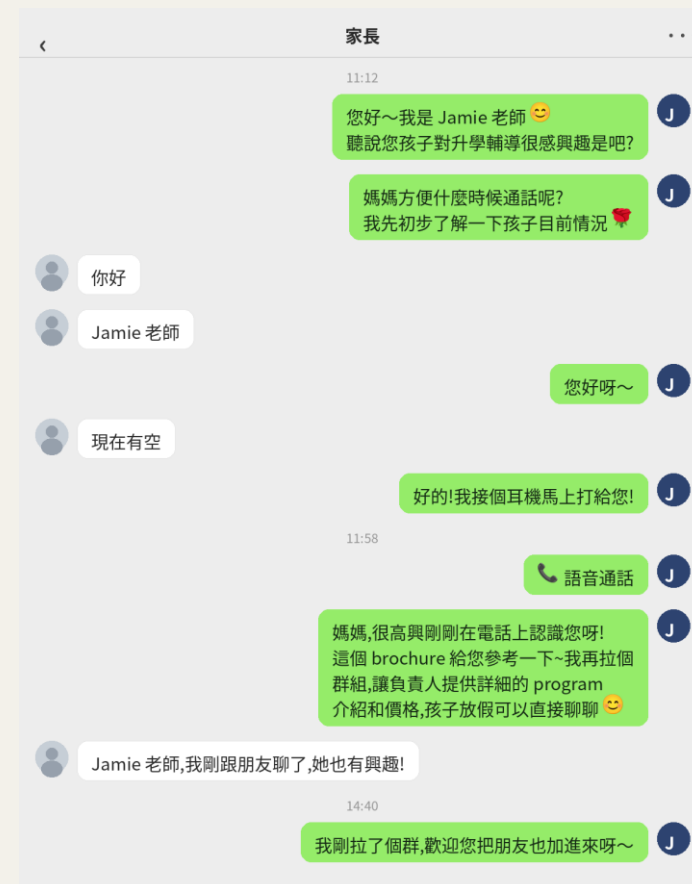
It was so lovely meeting you and your daughter at the event! I'd love to stay in touch and, if it's okay, share events and resources along the way that I think she'd enjoy as she explores her interests.

I actually know a few summer programs happening this summer that I think she'd love! Happy to send the details if you think your daughter would be interested — and happy to keep sharing more resources whenever they're useful. I'd love to be a resource for your family going forward 😊

Feel free to reach out anytime!

Warmly,
Jamie

Value-first cadence: at Grade 7 I'd lead with human development — emotional growth & interest exploration — not admissions; share useful resources & events (even non-Interface ones) so the relationship builds naturally.



Example: my real WeChat outreach style from past work (redacted)

Q3 · Discovery — understanding the family

Understand before I position. I let the parent talk first, then speak to whether & how Interface fits.

About the students

How do they feel about college admissions? What are they doing to prepare? Do they have a clear idea of which schools they're aiming for — and a possible major?

About the decision

What's prompting you to look at counseling now? What do you want help with — outcomes, direction, writing, or the process itself?

About the comparison

As you look at options, what matters most to you in choosing one?

Side note: in the rare case we're genuinely not a fit, I'd be honest about it — but my focus is always finding where Interface truly helps the family.

Q3 · Building trust, positioning effectively & spotting a strong fit

Guide the conversation

Listen first, pitch last — be the friend in the room, not a salesperson. Let the parent talk so I **understand the student & family** before positioning anything.

Position Interface effectively

Acknowledge the genuine strengths of other firms and the real differences — I know the landscape, so I can give an honest, insider comparison. Then name what makes Interface different: developmental & longitudinal (we build readiness over time, not last-minute), strong on family alignment, and still elite on admissions — and show why that fits this family.

What tells me it's a strong fit

Score each 1–5 → focus energy on hot leads.

Signal	What I look for
Engagement / openness	Real questions, shares openly, responsive
Need–fit	What they want matches Interface's strengths
Budget fit	Realistic for a multi-year, high-investment package
Decision timeline	How soon — close-now vs. nurture-and-stay-close



Q4 · Closing — the price-hesitant family

First I diagnose which family I'm dealing with — the play is different for each — before coming up with a strategic response. For example, there might be two types:

1 · Tight on budget

Genuinely interested, financially constrained

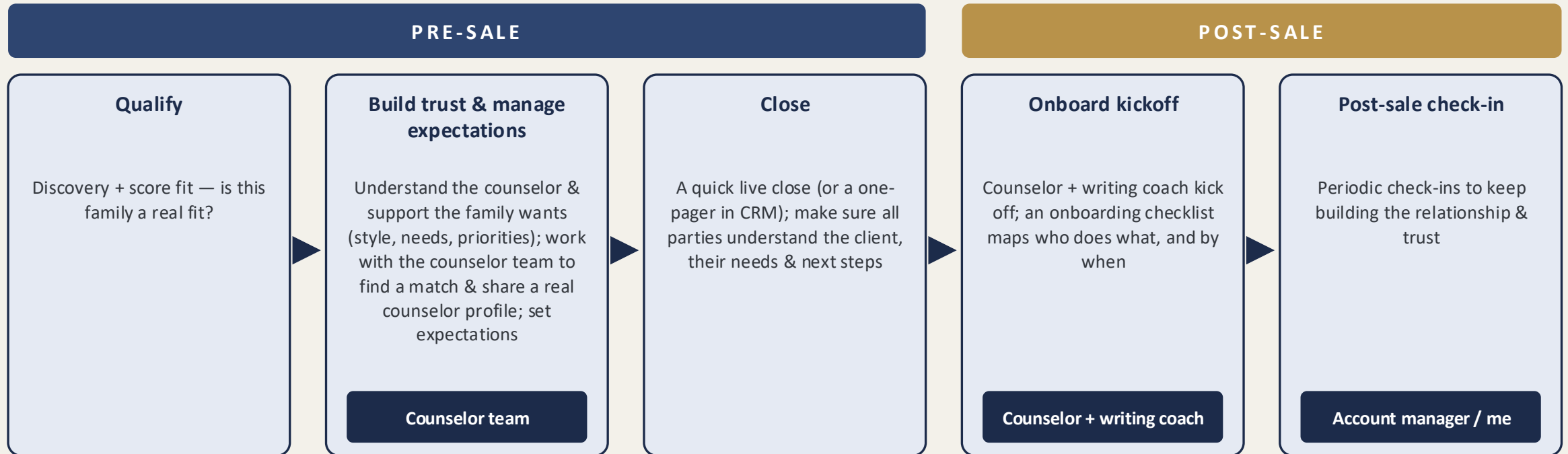
- Re-anchor on value first
- Flexible terms — installments / payment plan
- Scoped or tiered package — core now, add-ons later
- A discount only as a last-resort, policy-aligned exception — framed as something special for their situation

2 · Not yet sold on value

Can afford it, doubts it's worth it

- Pinpoint what they doubt — counselor? career support? outcomes?
- If it's the counselor → a conversation with a well-matched counselor to help win trust before they commit
- Right-size the package — start small, add on later

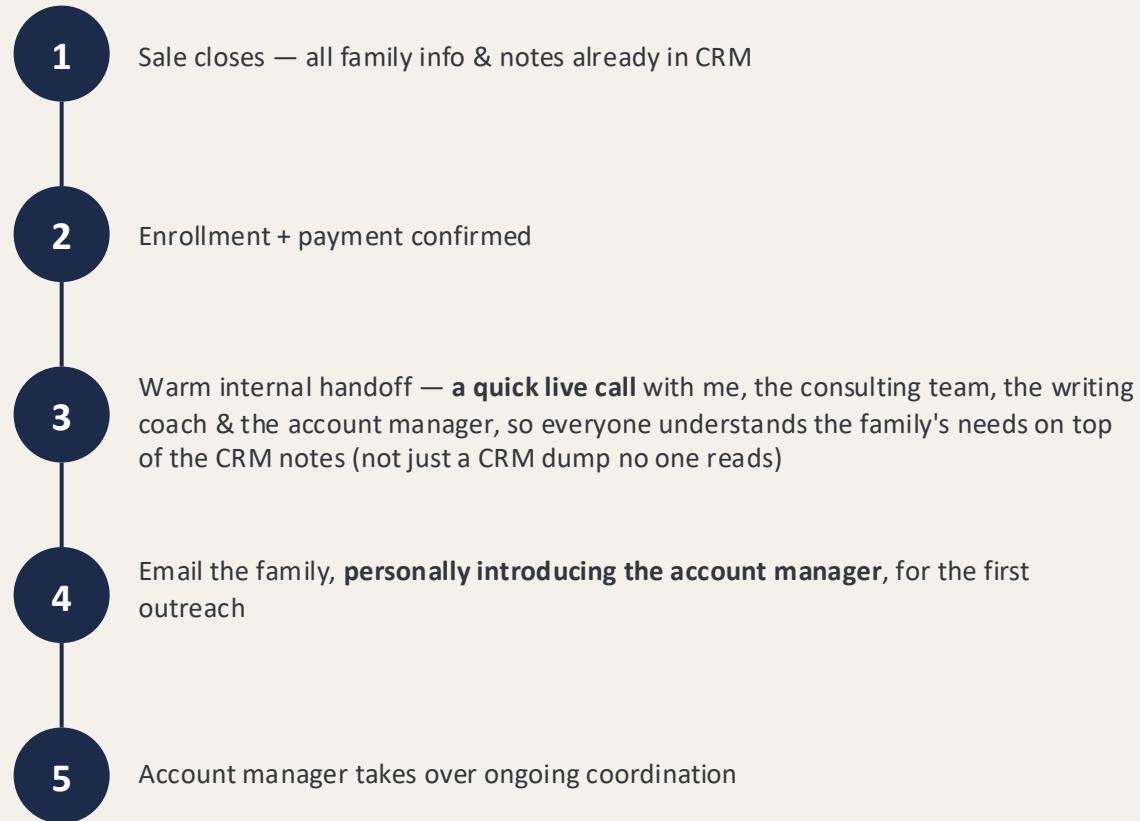
Q4 · Working the deal — stage by stage, with the team



Throughout: every conversation is logged in CRM → the counselor inherits the full picture, and the family never has to repeat themselves.

Q4 · Ideal sales → account-management handoff

Process



Tools

CRM

One shared record — profile, triggers, objections, notes & stage history

Handoff summary (from the live meeting)

Ideally AI-generated notes from that call with internal teams — the softer, qualitative context beyond CRM: the family's style, internal cues (what we can/can't do, what mom prefers), red flags to watch & their concerns

Onboarding checklist

Provide each team member's clear to-dos with timeframes — so every handoff follows the same repeatable steps

Summary: What I'd bring — four strengths & beliefs

The consistent thread across all four answers:

1

Research-driven strategy

I build strategy on research and real data — not instinct or opportunistic guesses.

2

A resource person, not a salesperson

I show up as the family's resource & problem-solver, grounded in understanding both the family and the market.

3

Genuine & confident advocacy

I'm confident in Interface and advocate for it — while giving the family genuine, objective feedback they can trust.

4

Organized & process-driven

I align teams and standardize the process, so the handoff is a seamless experience across pre- and post-sale.

Thank you! 😊